CIRC HQ STUDENT HANDOUT | GRADES 5 AND 6

Outdoor Classroom Redesign

Goal: Survey the existing outdoor classroom and design one realistic improvement for learning, accessibility, organization, shade, seating, or habitat.

35 minutes | 9 steps | Engineering and Design, Library and Information Literacy | Playbook B meeting 32

Ask | Plan | Build | Test | Improve

You are done when

Show the current-space evidence, identify the user need, and explain how the redesign improves that exact location.

You will use

- Clipboards
- Site maps
- Grid paper
- Pencils
- Rulers
- Tape measures
- Cardboard
- Tape
- Markers

Steps

35 minutes total. Your teacher says when to move on.

1 Step 1: Get ready — 3 min

- Clip the site map to your board.
- Choose one outdoor zone.

2 Step 2: Walk out — 2 min

- Walk with your design team.
- Stop at the assigned zone.

3 Step 3: Measure safely — 3 min

- Keep the tape measure below your waist.
- Leave plants untouched.
- Stay on the approved surface.

4 Step 4: Survey the zone — 8 min

- Record one feature that works.
- Record one learning problem.
- Measure the open space.

5 Step 5: Draw the redesign — 8 min

- Name the user.
- Draw the improvement on grid paper.
- Label the main measurements.

6 Step 6: Model one part — 4 min

- Build one key feature from paper.
- Check its size against the drawing.

7 Step 7: Pack the kit — 3 min

- Return each measuring tool.
- Place the model in the class tray.

8 Step 8: Return inside — 2 min

- Walk back with your design team.

9 Step 9: Exit check — 2 min

- Write one reason the redesign helps.

What to turn in

Your redesign with the user need and the location marked.

No computer? Another way to do it

Use photos or a map of the space indoors.

Finished early? Next challenge

One Better Detail: Add one sign, storage, seating, shade, or habitat detail and make a short materials list for it.

Stay safe

Stay inside outdoor boundaries, use measuring tools only as demonstrated, and do not climb, lift, dig, or disturb plants and animals.

Grade targets

Grade 5: Name one user need and sketch one change.
Grade 6: Use measurements to show the change fits the space.

Stuck? Try this order

1. Read the step again, out loud if you can.
2. Ask a partner at your table.
3. Raise your hand. Keep working on the next part while you wait.